

MAYAWATI IS BANKING ON A COMMISSIONED FILM TO MEND HER IMAGE



MAYAWATI

MANEESH AGNIHOTRI

LUCKNOW | Iron Maiden

Beleaguered Uttar Pradesh chief minister Mayawati is taking the celluloid route to unleash a counter offensive against her opponents. The state Information and Publicity Department has outsourced filmmakers to prepare a film on her achievements, projecting her as a no-nonsense administrator i.e. a 21st century Iron Lady. A senior officer on the project says, "We are clear about showing only achievements and the benefits extended to the public by the Government." Such indulgence isn't new for the big players in the state politics. Remember the laughable SP campaign with Amitabh Bachchan mouthing, "UP mein hai dum ky-onki jurm hai yahan kam". **by Subhash Mishra**

RANCHI | Power Failure

JHARKHAND HAS SEEN SIX CHIEF MINISTERS IN EIGHT YEARS AND NOW PRESIDENT'S RULE HAS BEEN IMPOSED ON THE STATE

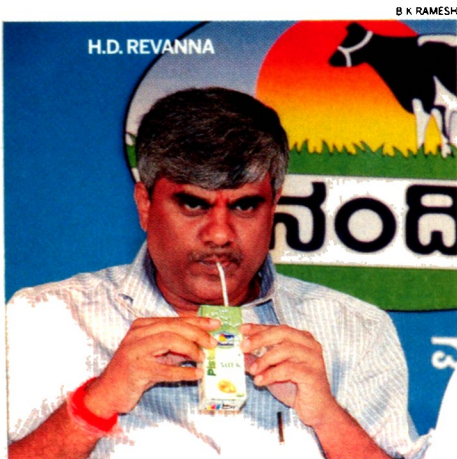
Jharkhand is once again in the news. The Centre's recent promulgation has brought the state under President's Rule. After chief minister Shibu Soren lost a by-poll, he tried to foist his nominee, Champai Soren, as his successor and demanded support from alliance partners, the Congress and the RJD—who refused. His alliance partner Lalu Prasad Yadav wanted former chief minister Madhu Koda to take over. The Centre was left with no option but to clamp President's Rule. And now with the Assembly under suspension, Jharkhand is still open to see the UPA allies work out yet another government.

by Amitabh Srivastava



SOREN

MANDEO SEN



H.D. REVANNA

B K RAMESH

BANGALORE | Milky Way

The ruling BJP has sought to extend its influence by opening up another front in the state. The party has taken on the Karnataka Milk Federation (KMF), the apex body of nearly 11,000 primary dairy cooperatives, by launching the BJP Milk Producers Cell. The real target are not hundreds of baffled milk manufacturers but rather KMF chairman H.D. Revanna—the JD(s) legislator and the son of H.D. Deve Gowda—who has been in control of the body for nearly 12 years. In August 2008, the BJP Government prevented Revanna's attempt to raise milk prices and around the same time, it also sent auditors to check KMF accounts. **by Stephen David**



golden pumpkin

HIS BROTHER ED, an environment expert and Cabinet minister, could have given David Miliband some tips about foot and mouth disease. But alas, the boyish, 40-something British foreign secretary seems to have been afflicted by the foot-and-mouth syndrome of the human kind. On his recent India visit, Miliband remained woefully detached from the ground realities of diplomacy. The big boo-boo was his statement linking Kashmir with terrorism in the region. Contrary to what Gordon Brown had said earlier, Miliband theorised that solving the Kashmir issue would deny extremists an operational alibi and thus allow Pakistan to tackle the threat on their western borders. Rather than presenting a somewhat convoluted reading of the modern Great Game, Miliband was perhaps merely showing off his ignorance.

David Miliband

